**NOTE** This sentence bears repeating: the order in which you add configuration providers to `ConfigurationManager` is important. Later configuration providers can overwrite the values of earlier providers.

Think of the configuration providers as adding layers of configuration values to a stack, where each layer may overlap some or all of the layers below, as shown in figure 10.3. If the new provider contains any keys that are already known to the `ConfigurationManager`, they overwrite the old values to create the final set of configuration values stored in `IConfiguration`.

**TIP** Instead of thinking in layers, you can think of the `ConfigurationManager` as a simple dictionary. When you add a provider, you're setting some key-value pairs. When you add a second provider, the provider can add new keys or overwrite the value of existing keys.

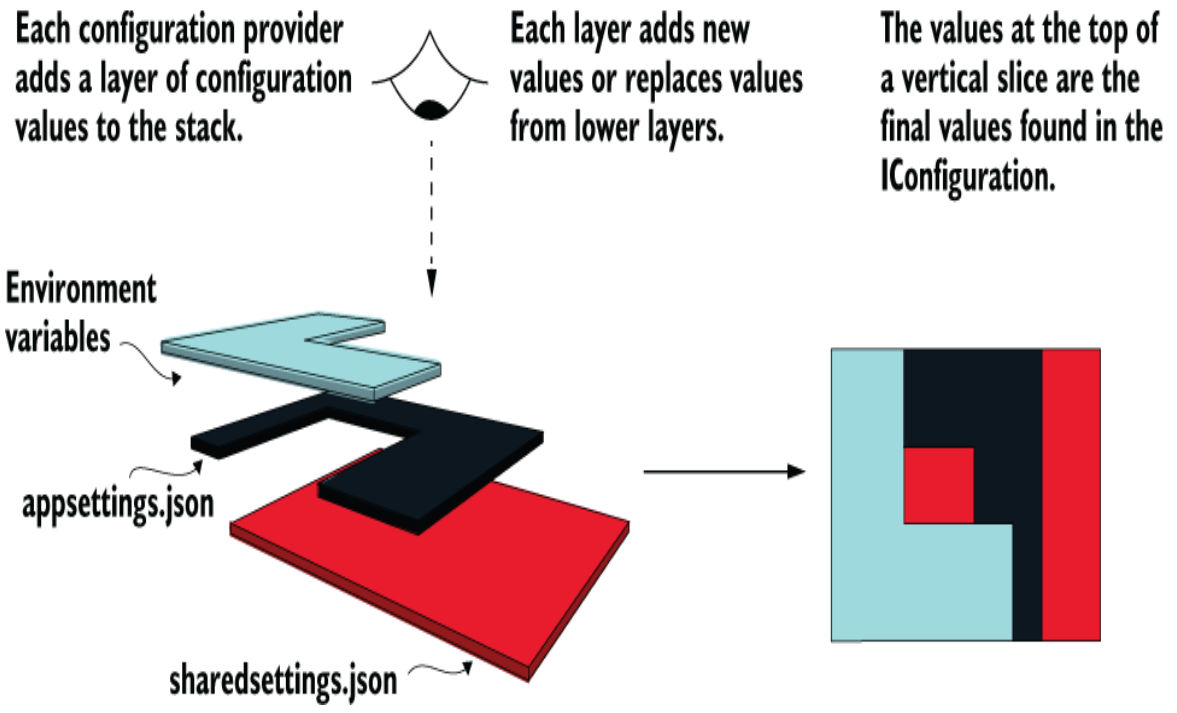



**Figure 10.3 Each configuration provider adds a layer of values to `ConfigurationBuilder`. Calling `Build()` collapses that configuration. Later**